

Jabra Elite 4

A couple of wins, a couple of misses

Hot on the heels of the Jabra Elite 5's launch in India, Jabra has introduced yet another contender in the high-end TWS earphones segment – the Jabra Elite 4. Just this year alone, we've had two fantastic additions to the price bracket the Elite 4 occupies – the wildly-hyped Nothing Ear (2) and the popular OnePlus Buds Pro 2. Naturally, I compared these earbuds to the Elite 4 thoroughly during our review process, and this is what I found out.

BUILD, DESIGN, AND FIT

The Jabra Elite 4 has a diminutive charging case, so portability isn't an issue – the case will easily slip into pockets or purses without bulging out too much. The case is also wieldy, you can easily flick the lid one with one hand. However, the materials definitely feel cheaper than the ones used on the Jabra Elite 5. The case's hinge feels slightly flimsy. The magnets holding the earphones inside the case aren't the strongest we've experienced, so there's room for improvement here. The overall look is clean and minimalistic, which we're fans of. The earbuds have an angled nozzle which improves the in-ear fit. The isolation was excellent. This is largely subjective, so we'd suggest you to go and try the buds out for yourself at stores. Add to that IP55 dust and water resistance, and you've got a solid pair of workout earbuds.

FEATURES

Jabra hasn't packed the Elite 4 with a smorgasbord of features. The ones it does have, are mostly well-implemented. The most eye-catching feature is Active Noise Cancellation, one that's present in most competitors at this price, so I'm glad Jabra didn't miss out on it. The Jabra Sound+ app is decently stocked when it comes to features, but there are a few vital missing pieces. There's the option to choose your voice assistant, activate Spotify Tap, keep your earbuds safe with Find My Jabra, and customise the ANC



cycle. Unfortunately, though, you cannot customise the earbud controls, at all. This is almost unacceptable since about 80-90 per cent of the earbuds we've tested at this price have this. Features that are missing are Qi wireless charging and on-ear detection – both of which are very common at this price.

PERFORMANCE

The Jabra Elite 4 has a bold yet balanced sound profile. The earphones have full-bodied, dynamic sound with a V-shaped signature. It is enjoyable for most modern genres of music. The soundstage is also decent and the imaging is excellent. I was able to place objects very accurately within the stage. With aptX support, the earphones produce sublime sound fidelity when listening to FLAC files. The Elite 4 definitely does better at maintaining the quality of vocals and lead instruments than the Nothing Ear (2). It also has more balanced-sounding bass. However, Nothing Ear (2) produces the highs slightly better. The only earphones that do a better job at this price are the OPPO Enco X2. Overall, a definite "go for it" from my end when it comes to sound quality alone. Moving on to ANC, it's decent for the

price. As for the microphone, while they picked up my voice well, the microphones also couldn't really mute out the ambient chatter. The Nothing Ear (2) does better in this regard, but the voice does sound slightly tinny.

BATTERY LIFE

In my testing, the Jabra Elite 4 recorded 21 hours and 6 minutes of total battery life on the Jabra Elite 4 while the Nothing Ear (2) only lasted for 18 hours and 48 minutes. The OnePlus Buds Pro 2, however, beats the Elite 4 with ease. The Elite 4's earbuds, by themselves, lasted for approximately 5 hours and 15 minutes with ANC and aptX turned on, which is fantastic. You also get fast charging support, a 10-minute charge will provide an hour of music playback. Also, the earphones don't support Qi wireless charging, which is standard at this price.

VERDICT

The Jabra Elite 4 checks a fair number of boxes – impressive sound quality, good battery life, serviceable ANC, and

a compact build. The fact that the Jabra Elite 4 lacks AAC codec support means that it cannot be recommended to iPhone users. So, if you are NOT an iPhone user and want a solid pair of TWS earphones under ₹10K for your Android device – you can consider the Jabra Elite 4. It's got the looks and the sound, but don't miss out on other competing devices such as the OPPO Enco X2 and the OnePlus Buds Pro 2 which could be better options for you.

–Dhriti Datta

SPECIFICATIONS

Driver size: 6 mm | Speaker frequency response: 20 Hz - 20 kHz | Audio codecs: aptX, SBC | Microphone: 4x MEMS | Bluetooth version: 5.2 | Bluetooth multipoint: Yes | App: Jabra Sound+ | IP Rating: IP55 | Earbud weight: 4.6 g (each) | Battery life: 7 hours (earbuds), 28 hours (earbuds + case) | Battery life with ANC active: 5.5 hours (earbuds), 22 hours (earbuds + case) | Fast charge: Yes, 10 minutes charge = 1 hour

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